MIRROR IMAGE (5E, 2024 RULES) – DESCRIPTION

Level 2 – Illusion
Casting Time: Action · Range: Self
Components: V, S · Duration: 1 minute (no Concentration)
Classes: Bard, Sorcerer, Warlock, Wizard

Three **illusory duplicates** of yourself appear in your space. For the duration, they move with you and mimic your actions, shifting position so it's impossible to track which is real. You can use your action to dismiss them.

Each time a creature targets you with an attack roll, roll a d20 to see if the attack targets a duplicate instead. With three duplicates, you need a **6 or higher**; with two, an **8 or higher**; with one, an **11 or higher**. A duplicate's AC is **10 + your Dexterity modifier**. If an attack hits a duplicate, it is destroyed. A duplicate is destroyed only by an attack that hits it: it ignores all other damage and effects.

The spell ends when all three duplicates are destroyed. A creature with Blindsight or Truesight is unaffected.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. You create three illusory duplicates.
2. Each attack against you: d20 to see if a duplicate is targeted (6+, 8+, or 11+).
3. A duplicate's AC: 10 + Dexterity.
4. A hit duplicate is destroyed; the spell ends when all three are gone.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The text doesn't say who rolls the d20 or when, or how to treat spells that require a ranged attack roll. Fix: the DM announces who rolls and when.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe several identical silhouettes swaying, crossing, and blurring the enemy's gaze.

Step 1 – Cast the spell:

Action, components V, S. Three duplicates appear in your space for 1 minute, no Concentration.

Step 2 – When you are attacked:

Before the attack roll, roll a d20: three duplicates, 6 or higher; two, 8 or higher; one, 11 or higher. On a success, the attack targets a duplicate.

Step 3 – Against a duplicate:

The duplicate's AC is 10 + your Dexterity modifier. If the attack hits, the duplicate is destroyed.

Step 4 – End of the spell:

When all three duplicates are destroyed, after 1 minute, or if you dismiss them with an action.

Example: Eliot (Dexterity +2) casts Mirror Image. A bandit attacks him: d20 = 9, higher than 6: the attack targets a duplicate (AC 12). It rolls 13: a hit, the duplicate is destroyed. Two duplicates remain.

MIRROR IMAGE (5E, 2024 RULES) – Q&A AND DEBATE

⚠ Common questions:

Is Concentration required?

No: the spell lasts 1 minute without Concentration.

What if an attack hits a duplicate?

The duplicate is destroyed, you take nothing.

What destroys a duplicate?

Only an attack that hits it.

Does an area spell destroy a duplicate?

No: a duplicate ignores all other damage and effects.

What is a duplicate's AC?

10 + your Dexterity modifier.

Can I dismiss the duplicates?

Yes, with an action.

Who is unaffected?

A creature with Blindsight or Truesight.

⚠ Debate points and table options:

Table rule

Who rolls the die?

The text doesn't say. **Option**: the spell's caster rolls the d20; or the DM, in secret.

Ranged attacks

The spell applies to any attack roll. **Option**: follow the text.

Spells with saving throws

These spells don't target with an attack roll: the spell doesn't work. **Option**: keep it.

Creatures that aren't fooled

Blindsight or Truesight negates the spell. **Option**: the DM decides for other senses (smell, hearing).

Duration and Concentration

The spell lasts 1 minute without Concentration. **Option**: keep it.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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